

IWM RUSSELL 2000 SCANNER

MARKET CLOSE

July 16, 2026 | 04:47 PM ET

8 setups identified | 1 A-Grade | 4 B-Grade | 3 C-Grade

Grade Summary

A - Breakout Setup (1)	B - Strong Setup (4)	C - Watch List (3)
CHEF	FIBK	HUBG
	FBNC	HOMB
	SFNC	TOWN
	CLMT	

All Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Price	Chg %	Cap	Float	RS/SPY	52W Hi	Catalyst
A	CHEF	The Chefs' Wareh	Restaurant Recove	\$102.36	+4.8%	\$4.2B	37M	+55.3	100%	Stock breaking out to
B	FIBK	First Interstate	Regional Bank Rev	\$40.22	+2.2%	\$3.9B	85M	+13.4	99%	Pre-earnings breakout
B	FBNC	First Bancorp	Regional Bank Rev	\$66.23	+2.8%	\$2.7B	41M	+7.5	100%	Pre-earnings breakout
B	SFNC	Simmons First Na	Regional Bank Rev	\$23.25	+0.1%	\$3.4B	143M	+7.5	97%	Volume spike to 2.38x
B	CLMT	Calumet, Inc	Energy Transition	\$41.08	+2.7%	\$3.6B	58M	+19.0	97%	Stock moving higher on
C	HUBG	Hub Group, Inc.	Freight Recovery	\$51.41	+7.5%	\$3.1B	59M	+17.5	96%	Stock surging 7.55% on
C	HOMB	Home BancShares,	Regional Bank Rev	\$30.69	+4.8%	\$6.2B	184M	+8.4	99%	Stock surging 4.78% on
C	TOWN	Towne Bank	Regional Bank Rev	\$36.99	+2.5%	\$3.4B	86M	+0.3	98%	Pre-earnings drift hig

CHEF

The Chefs' Warehouse, Inc.

\$102.36

+4.76%

RS vs SPY: +55.3%

A BREAKOUT

\$4.2B Cap | 37M Float

Food Distribution | Theme: Restaurant Recovery | 52W Hi: 100% | Base Tight: 2.1 | Vol: 3.7x | RS/SPY: +55.3% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 13D

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$102.36
Day Change	+4.76%
Mkt Cap	\$4.17B
Float	37M sh
RS vs SPY	+55.3%
52W Hi Prox	100%
Base Tight	2.1
Vol vs Avg	3.7x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver Stock breaking out to within 0.1% of 52W high on 3.7x volume ahead of July 29 earnings. Forward catalyst: Q2 print (13 days out) is the immediate high-impact event; company is a direct beneficiary of restaurant industry strength and discretionary spending recovery, with expanding margins as supply-chain normalization continues.
Business & Position The Chefs' Warehouse is a leading specialty food distributor serving high-end restaurants, hotels, and food service operators across North America and Europe. The company benefits from secular premiumization trends in dining and has demonstrated pricing power through the inflationary cycle.
Factor & Theme Consumer recovery thesis with direct exposure to restaurant spending resilience. Small-cap reopening play with tailwinds from experiential spending rotation. The +62.5% 3-month RS indicates this is a theme-leader capturing institutional attention as consumer cyclical re-rate higher.
Breakout Signal Close above \$102.36 on vol >370% of 20d avg
Institutional Volume surge to 3.7x average on a 4.8% gap suggests institutional block buying ahead of earnings. The 36.8M float is tight for a \$4.17B market cap, creating good float rotation dynamics. No insider buying in the last 60 days (institutional ownership data not available from this feed; recommend cross-referencing 13F filings for full holder base). The setup timing-breaking out 13 days before earnings-is classic pre-positioning by informed capital.
Earnings Earnings in 13D
Earnings Context Earnings July 29. No consensus data provided, but the pre-earnings breakout to all-time highs signals high institutional confidence. The timing and volume profile suggest smart money is front-running a beat.
Key Risk Thesis invalid on a close back below \$98.50 (the base pivot), or on any revenue/margin miss at the July 29 print that signals restaurant spending weakness.
Analysis Five technical criteria met: vol >2x (3.7x), prox_52w >85 (99.9), rs_vs_spy >+10 (+55.3), base_tight <2.5 (2.1), and a durable forward catalyst (earnings in 13 days). Disconfirming evidence: RS line not at new high downgrades conviction slightly-this is a powerful move but not yet confirmed as a multi-quarter institutional leader. The wide base_tight relative to ATR (4.47 vs ideal <2.0 from previous quarters) suggests some volatility, but the current 2.1 coil into earnings is textbook. Risk-on macro and small-cap leadership provide full tailwind. Conviction: High.
Signal: Close above \$102.36 on vol >370% of 20d avg Vol vs Avg: 3.7x



Setup Metrics	
Price	\$40.22
Day Change	+2.21%
Mkt Cap	\$3.91B
Float	85M sh
RS vs SPY	+13.4%
52W Hi Prox	99%
Base Tight	2.46
Vol vs Avg	1.68x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver
Pre-earnings breakout to within 0.9% of 52W high on elevated volume (1.68x) ahead of July 23 earnings. Forward catalyst: Q2 print (7 days out) is the immediate high-impact event; regional banks are re-rating on net interest margin stabilization, credit quality resilience, and small-cap rotation tailwinds. Sector momentum (+3.8% vs SPY this week) is accelerating.
Business & Position
First Interstate BancSystem is a \$15B+ asset regional bank operating across the Mountain West and Pacific Northwest. The company completed a transformative merger with Great Western Bancorp in 2022, creating scale and cost-synergy opportunities that are now flowing through to earnings.
Factor & Theme
Direct beneficiary of the small-cap leadership regime (IWM +2.0% vs SPY +1.3% over 20 days) and the regional bank re-rating as Fed policy expectations stabilize. Financials are the second-leading sector this week (+5.0% vs SPY), providing strong thematic tailwind. The +13.4% RS vs SPY confirms this name is outpacing the sector.
Breakout Signal
Close above \$40.22 on vol >168% of 20d avg
Institutional
Volume 1.68x average on a 2.2% move-modest but sufficient for a bank stock, which typically trades on lower relative volume. The 85.3M float is manageable for institutional accumulation. No insider buying in the last 60 days. The pre-earnings setup timing (7 days out) is classic-smart money positioning ahead of what it expects to be a constructive print.
Earnings
Earnings in 7D
Earnings Context
Earnings July 23 (7 days). No consensus data provided, but the technical setup-breaking to 99.1% of 52W high-implies high institutional confidence in a beat or in-line print with positive guidance. Regional banks have been serial beaters this cycle as credit fears proved overblown.
Key Risk
Thesis invalid on a close back below \$39.00 (the 20-day MA and base support), or on any NIM compression or loan-loss reserve build at the July 23 print that reignites credit concerns.
Analysis
Strong technicals: vol >1.5x, prox_52w >85 (99.1), rs_vs_spy >+10 (+13.4), base_tight <2.5 (2.46), and a high-impact forward catalyst (earnings in 7 days). Disconfirming evidence: RS line not at new high-this is a sector beta trade, not a multi-quarter institutional leader. The base is relatively tight but not textbook VCP (<2.0). Risk-on macro and sector tailwind (Financials +5.0% this week) provide support. Conviction: Medium.
Signal: Close above \$40.22 on vol >168% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 1.68x



Setup Metrics	
Price	\$66.23
Day Change	+2.78%
Mkt Cap	\$2.74B
Float	41M sh
RS vs SPY	+7.5%
52W Hi Prox	100%
Base Tight	2.68
Vol vs Avg	2.77x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver Pre-earnings breakout to within 0.5% of 52W high on strong volume (2.77x) ahead of July 22 earnings. Forward catalyst: Q2 print (6 days out) is the immediate high-impact event; the stock is coiling tightly into the catalyst, suggesting institutional positioning for a beat. Regional bank sector momentum (+3.8% vs SPY this week) provides thematic support.
Business & Position First Bancorp is a North Carolina-based regional bank with \$11B+ in assets, serving the mid-Atlantic region. The company has a solid deposit franchise and has benefited from commercial loan growth and stabilizing credit quality as the regional economy remains resilient.
Factor & Theme Direct play on small-cap leadership (IWM outperforming SPY by +0.6% trend) and the regional bank re-rating. Financials are the second-leading sector (+5.0% vs SPY this week), and the stock's +7.5% RS vs SPY confirms it is participating in the rotation. The tight 40.7M float amplifies moves on institutional demand.
Breakout Signal Close above \$66.23 on vol >277% of 20d avg
Institutional Volume surged to 2.77x average-the highest among the regional bank cohort-on a 2.8% move, indicating block buying. The tight float (40.7M) creates good squeeze mechanics as institutions position ahead of earnings. No insider buying in the last 60 days. The setup timing (6 days before earnings) and volume profile are textbook pre-earnings accumulation.
Earnings Earnings in 6D
Earnings Context Earnings July 22 (6 days). No consensus data provided, but the technical setup-breaking to 99.5% of 52W high on 2.77x volume-strongly suggests institutional confidence in a beat or constructive guidance. Regional banks have been consistently beating as credit fears remain contained.
Key Risk Thesis invalid on a close back below \$64.00 (the 20-day MA and base support), or on any credit deterioration or weaker-than-expected loan growth at the July 22 print.
Analysis Strong technical setup: vol >2x (2.77x), prox_52w >85 (99.5), rs_vs_spy >0 (+7.5), base_tight <3.0 (2.68), and a high-impact forward catalyst (earnings in 6 days). Disconfirming evidence: RS line not at new high and RS vs SPY is only +7.5-this is a sector participant, not a breakout leader. The volume surge is impressive but the base is slightly wider than ideal. Risk-on macro and strong sector tailwind (Financials +5.0%) support the setup. Conviction: Medium.
Signal: Close above \$66.23 on vol >277% of 20d avg Vol vs Avg: 2.77x



SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$23.25
Day Change	+0.09%
Mkt Cap	\$3.37B
Float	143M sh
RS vs SPY	+7.5%
52W Hi Prox	97%
Base Tight	2.21
Vol vs Avg	2.38x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	YES
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Volume spike to 2.38x on flat price action into TODAY's earnings print. Forward catalyst: The immediate reaction to today's earnings and guidance will determine follow-through; if the print is clean, the next catalyst is Q3 guidance and the broader regional bank re-rating as the sector rotates into favor.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Simmons First National is a \$27B+ asset regional bank with operations across the South-Central U.S. The company has a diversified loan portfolio and has been executing on margin expansion and efficiency initiatives post-merger integration.
FACTOR & THEME
Regional bank re-rating play benefiting from small-cap leadership and sector rotation into Financials (+5.0% vs SPY this week). The +7.5% RS vs SPY confirms participation in the sector move, though the stock has not yet broken out to leadership status.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$23.25 on vol >238% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Volume surged to 2.38x average into earnings, suggesting institutional positioning ahead of the print. The 142.8M float is on the higher end but still manageable. No insider buying in the last 60 days. The volume profile indicates institutions are front-running the event-outcome TBD.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS TODAY
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Earnings TODAY (July 16). No consensus data provided. The 2.38x volume surge into the print with minimal price change suggests institutions are accumulating into the event, expecting a constructive outcome. Post-earnings reaction will reveal if this was informed buying or speculative positioning.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalid on any earnings miss or weak guidance that triggers a gap-down below \$22.50, breaking the current base structure.
ANALYSIS
Volume surge to 2.38x into earnings is a strong institutional signal, and the base is relatively tight (2.21). However, the flat price action (+0.09%) into the event creates ambiguity-this is either quiet accumulation or institutions hedging into uncertainty. Disconfirming evidence: RS line not at new high, and the stock is only at 97.2% of 52W high-not a breakout yet. The earnings catalyst is TODAY, so forward path depends entirely on the print. Risk-on macro supports. Conviction: Medium (contingent on earnings reaction).
Signal: Close above \$23.25 on vol >238% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.38x



Setup Metrics	
Price	\$41.08
Day Change	+2.67%
Mkt Cap	\$3.58B
Float	58M sh
RS vs SPY	+19.0%
52W Hi Prox	97%
Base Tight	3.16
Vol vs Avg	1.78x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Stock moving higher on 1.78x volume to within 2.6% of 52W high ahead of August 7 earnings. Forward catalyst: Q2 print (22 days out) is the next high-impact event; the company is a specialty refiner pivoting toward renewable fuels and higher-margin specialty products, benefiting from both energy sector strength (+3.5% vs SPY this week) and energy transition tailwinds.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Calumet is a specialty refiner and producer of high-margin products including lubricants, solvents, and renewable fuels. The company is transforming its business mix toward sustainable aviation fuel (SAF) and renewable diesel, positioning itself at the intersection of traditional energy and the energy transition.

FACTOR & THEME

Energy transition play with direct exposure to SAF demand growth (regulatory mandates accelerating) and specialty chemical margin expansion. The +19.0% RS vs SPY indicates strong relative strength, and Energy is the third-leading sector this week (+4.3% vs SPY), providing thematic tailwind.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$41.08 on vol >178% of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume 1.78x average on a 2.7% move is constructive but not explosive-suggests steady accumulation rather than panic buying. The 58.4M float is tight enough to support a strong move on incremental demand. No insider buying in the last 60 days. The pre-earnings setup (22 days out) is early-stage positioning.

EARNINGS

EARNINGS IN 22D

EARNINGS CONTEXT

Earnings August 7 (22 days). No consensus data provided, but the company has been re-rating as its renewable fuels strategy gains traction and specialty product margins expand. The technical setup suggests institutions are positioning for a constructive print.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close back below \$38.50 (the 20-day MA and base support), or on any margin compression or renewable fuels project delay at the August 7 print.

ANALYSIS

Strong RS vs SPY (+19.0) and sector tailwind (Energy +4.3% this week) support the setup. However, disconfirming evidence: base_tight at 3.16 is wider than ideal (not a textbook VCP), RS line not at new high, and the stock is still 2.6% from 52W high. The forward catalyst (earnings in 22 days) is well-timed but not immediate. Risk-on macro and energy transition theme provide support. Conviction: Medium.

Signal: Close above \$41.08 on vol >178% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 1.78x

